

The Curriculum Framework

The MOTM curriculum is a holistic approach to mindfulness for martial artists and athletes. Lessons are split into four modules that build awareness from the ground up:

Module	Theme	Core Focus
I — BREATH	Month 1	Harnessing energy, grounding, emotional regulation through breath
II — BODY	Month 2	Proprioception, tension release, physical alignment and grounding
III — MIND	Month 3	Zanshin (awareness), Mushin (no mind), mental flexibility
IV — SPIRIT	Month 4	Flow state, purpose, equanimity, self-compassion

Scripts vs. Challenges

Scripts are guided exercises read to students while they are in a meditative stance (on their knees, in a horse stance, or in a comfortable stable position). Run one script per class session, at the opening or close of class (3–5 minutes).

Challenges are integration activities meant to be woven into the martial arts lesson itself — during forms, sparring, or drills. They make the script functional by asking students to apply the concept while training.

Being Trauma-Informed

Every student has their own past experiences, culture, and background. Sometimes students have experienced emotional or physical trauma that can make looking inward uncomfortable or even feel dangerous. Always give students an "out" before every exercise:

"If at any point this exercise becomes too uncomfortable and you need to stop or take a break, please do so."

It is important for students to build tolerance to their experience, but it is equally important that no student is re-traumatized and that everyone feels safe on the mats.

Inviting the Sidelines

Do not hesitate to invite parents and guardians observing the class to participate from their seats. When parents engage alongside their children, they powerfully model self-regulation. This shared experience brings the calm of the dojo into the home and creates a common language for handling stress.

Age Group Guidance

Age Group	Which Scripts to Use	Instructor Notes
Ages 3–6 (Young Warriors)	Young Warriors scripts included at the end of each Module PDF	Use playful, game-based language. Movement is encouraged.
Ages 7–11 (Twens)	Young Warriors scripts with more mature naming (e.g., "Vibration Breath" instead of "Bumblebee Breath")	Rename exercises to sound less childish. Bridge to adult concepts.
Ages 12+ (Teens & Adults)	Standard adult scripts in each Module PDF	Focus heavily on performance benefits: reaction time, power, mental edge. Avoid emotional framing.

Teaching Teens: The Performance Pivot

Teenagers are often self-conscious. When teaching them, focus heavily on the **performance benefits** — reaction time, power, speed, mental edge — rather than the emotional benefits. If they believe it will make them a better fighter, they will buy in. Use language from the Troubleshooting Guide (included in your Resource Pack): "We are thickening the prefrontal cortex so you don't freeze in a real fight. This is brain conditioning."